

Naughty Tales

Editorial Review Guide

Author: Jaylonna Stevette

Prepared for author review. This guide is focused on developmental and editorial decisions before the book moves deeper into production.

Current Review Status

J Merrill Publishing has prepared the current manuscript as an author-review manuscript. The manuscript is a mature short-story collection with explicit adult content. The review at this stage should focus on structure, author intent, reader experience, consistency, and readiness for the next editing or production step.

What To Review First

- Confirm that the title should appear as Naughty Tales and the author should appear as Jaylonna Stevette.
- Confirm whether the chapter order is final: Chapters 1 through 14 followed by the four-part Candace closing sequence.
- Confirm whether all post-story summaries should remain in the author-facing book, be revised, or be removed before production.
- Confirm whether the author bio and Also by Jaylonna Stevette section are final or need updated book names.
- Confirm whether mature-content positioning, back-cover language, and retail-category expectations should be reviewed before distribution.

Developmental Notes

- The collection has a clear tonal identity: confessional, sensual, direct, comic in places, and centered on female agency and desire.
- Several stories use recurring commentary after the narrative. Decide whether those summaries are part of the reading experience or editorial scaffolding that should be removed before publication.
- The Tabby arc opens the collection with a strong voice and clear domestic-conflict engine. Later pieces broaden the premise into other narrators and situations; author review should confirm that this widening is intentional.
- The Candace sequence functions like a finale and should be reviewed as a connected multi-part ending, not as four isolated chapters.
- Because the manuscript is explicit, retail readiness should include category, audience, and description decisions before public listing.

Line And Copyediting Watch Points

- Confirm consistency for character names, recurring phrases, and chapter titles.
- Review punctuation and dialogue formatting in scripted exchanges.
- Check capitalization and styling for product, place, and series names.
- Review tense consistency within each story.
- Confirm whether informal spellings, direct address, and slang are intentional voice choices.

Author Decisions Needed

- Approve the title and author credit as shown in the review manuscript.
- Approve, revise, or remove the post-story summaries.
- Approve the chapter order and the placement of the Candace four-part sequence.
- Provide final About the Author text.
- Provide final Also by Jaylonna Stevette titles or approve removal of placeholders.
- Confirm whether the manuscript should proceed to line editing after this developmental review.

Next Step After Author Review

Once the author returns decisions, J Merrill Publishing can move the manuscript into the next approved editorial step. If the author approves the structure and supplies missing front/back matter, the next likely action is line editing. If the author requests structural changes, the manuscript should remain in developmental review until those decisions are resolved.

Quality Check

- Author-review manuscript opens successfully.
- No tracked changes were detected in the source manuscript.
- No comments were detected in the source manuscript.
- No internal process markers were detected in the source manuscript.
- Title and author placeholders were corrected in the author-review manuscript copy.